

Performance Reflections for Individuals

Introduction

Performance Reflections are an important part of your DeepL Journey that, when conducted effectively, can fuel your success and growth. This is an opportunity to reflect on your own impact, share and receive feedback from your lead and peers, and have a meaningful conversation with your lead focused on your performance and development.

This guide helps you understand the key actions in the cycle, what needs to happen when, as well as some tactical tips and strategies to ensure the time you invest yields valuable impact, unlocking your potential and sustaining progress.

Table of contents

-  TL;DR
-  Performance Timeline
 -  Key Dates for 2025
 -  Annual Timeline Overview
-  Self-Reflection
-  Upwards Feedback
-  Peer Feedback
 -  Requesting Peer Feedback
 -  Sharing Peer Feedback
-  FAQs
 -  Performance Reflections - Overall
 -  Self-Reflection
 -  Upwards Feedback
 -  Peer Feedback
 -  Resources & Support

Resources

- [Performance and Growth Framework](#)
- [Navigating Feedback](#)
- [Personal Development Plan](#)
- [DeepL values](#)
- [Goal Setting](#)
- [Growth Mindset](#)
- [Self-Reflection Example](#)
- [Glossary of Key Terms](#)

This topic applies to...

     All employees.

Contacts

For any queries → reach out to **your People Business Partner**.

TL;DR

The performance reflection process will **kick off on January 6 2025**. The key dates and deadlines you need to know for the upcoming cycle are listed [here](#).

During **Self-Reflection**, you'll reflect back on 2024 and focus on your contributions (3-5 key contributions/achievements), behaviours (2-3 examples), and one area for development. This aim is to celebrate your work, address growth areas, and set the stage for a meaningful Performance Conversation with your lead.

For **Upwards Feedback**, share observations on your lead's strengths and areas for improvement in supporting you, the team, and their impact to the organisation.

Peer Feedback involves highlighting strengths and growth areas for 3 peers, focusing on collaboration, impact, skill mastery, and growth mindset.

Your to-do checklist:

- ☐ Align on your individual goals with your lead and add them in Bob between **6-31 January**.
- ☐ Complete your Self-Reflection in Bob between **6-24 January** (if you are [eligible](#)).
- ☐ Complete the Upwards and Peer Feedback assigned to you in Bob between **6-24 January**.

Performance Timeline

Key Dates for 2025

The dates **highlighted** are those that require your participation:

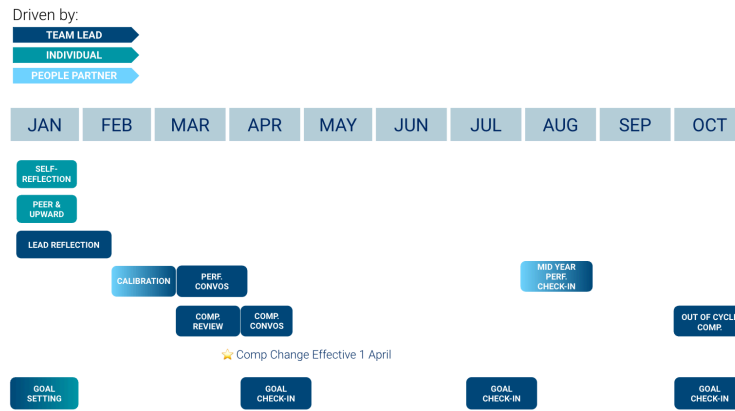
- **6-31 January**: Set [your Goals](#) for the following year with your Lead
- **6 - 24 January**: Complete your [Self-Reflection](#), [Upwards Feedback](#) & [Peer Feedback](#)
- **6 January - 11 February**: Leads complete their Lead Reflections
- **17 February - 6 March**: Performance Calibration Sessions
- **10 March - 4 April**: Performance Conversations
- **11 March - 4 April**: Salary Review
- **11 - 24 April**: Salary Conversations

Note: the reflection process only applies for [individuals who are eligible](#).

 Are you still...

- Wondering why there is a gap between your Self-Reflection and Performance Conversation? [Check out our FAQ here](#).
- Looking to understand how the above activities are connected? [Check out our FAQ here](#).

Annual Timeline Overview



Self-Reflection

The **aim** of the self-reflection is to help you reflect on your performance and development.

By reflecting on your contributions and/or achievements, your behaviours and approach to your work, and potential areas for growth and development, you can determine the best steps to help you succeed here at DeepL while setting yourself up for a meaningful Performance Conversation with your lead.

Please keep in mind that the self-reflection is not intended as an activity to solely highlight the positive aspects of your work. Although the process does aim to celebrate your efforts and contributions, it is also intended as a retrospective for you to focus on your opportunities for improvement. We can all benefit from regularly reflecting on our impact and the way we get things done. It is important to share all of these aspects with your lead, so that they can also consider your perspective when completing their reflection.

What will I need to do?

During the self-reflection, you will be asked to introspect and write your inputs on three topics: the '**what**', the '**how**' and your own **development**.

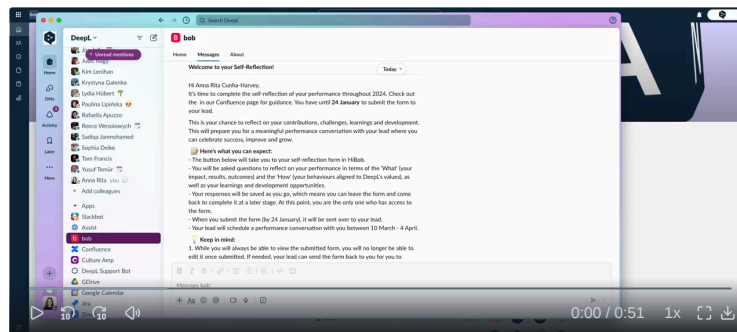
- **The What:** Reflect on 3-5 contributions or achievements you've made throughout the [reflection period](#).
Think about the value you have delivered for your customers, and the impact you've made on your team's and the company's objectives. How you create impact will vary based on your function and role, it could be delivering great experience, driving operational efficiencies or company growth.
- **The How:** Reflect on 2-3 examples that demonstrate how your behaviours and approach contributed to your impact and outcomes.
Think about how you collaborated, communicated, influenced, took decisive action, fostered a growth mindset, developed skills, and enriched DeepL's culture in line with our values.
- **Development:** Think about one area you can focus on to enhance your impact and outline the steps you will take to achieve this.

For additional tips and guidance on completing each section, check out our [guide here](#).

Important: Be sure to Submit your Self-Reflection by the deadline. This will NOT be automatically submitted on your behalf.

What will this look like in HiBob?

Check out the video below for a preview of the Self-Reflection form in HiBob:



Performance Conversation with your lead

After the Lead Reflections and calibration are complete, it will be time for you sit down with your lead and have a Performance Conversation. This is an opportunity to discuss your Self-Reflection, celebrate your efforts, listen to feedback from your lead, peers and direct reports (if applicable) and discuss development together.

Consider these tips for a meaningful conversation:

✓ 🗨️ Check your environment

- Consider how you are feeling, are you in a fixed or growth mindset coming into the conversation?
- Are you in a private space where you can both talk freely?
- Have you switched off any distractions? Is there anything holding either of you back from being fully present?

✓ 🗨️ Share

- Share your self-reflection including your efforts, accomplishments and areas of opportunity.

✓ 🗨️ Listen

- Listen openly and with a growth mindset. Remember that tricky amygdala in your brain can get triggered by constructive feedback, but feedback is an incredible opportunity to learn.
- Remember that your lead is invested in you, and wants the best for your development.
- Ask open-ended questions to understand their viewpoints.

✓ 🗨️ Discuss

- Collectively identify development goals based on your aspirations and the feedback shared.

🗨️ Follow-Up

- If you already have a Personal Development Plan, reflect on whether you want to update it based on your reflection and the feedback you received.
- If you haven't got a Personal Development plan yet, now is a great time to start. Check out [this workbook](#) to start Discovery, Planning and Action.

Still have questions about your Self-Reflection? Check out the [self-reflection section of our FAQs](#) for more information!

UP! Upwards Feedback

The **aim** of upwards feedback is for you to provide insights on your leaders performance so that they can understand their strengths and areas for improvement.

What will I need to do?

You'll be asked to answer **two questions** based on your observations, and experiences with your lead.

The first question relates to the strengths you have observed in your lead and the second to their areas of improvement. For both questions, you should reflect on:

1. How they lead and support **you as an individual**.
2. How they lead and support **your team**.
3. How they drive impact across **the organisation**.

We have opted for this feedback to be transparent, so your lead will be able to see what you have written when they receive their reflection later. We recognise not everyone will feel comfortable sharing feedback openly, so if you do have feedback you do not feel safe to share we encourage you to chat with your lead's lead or your People Business Partner.

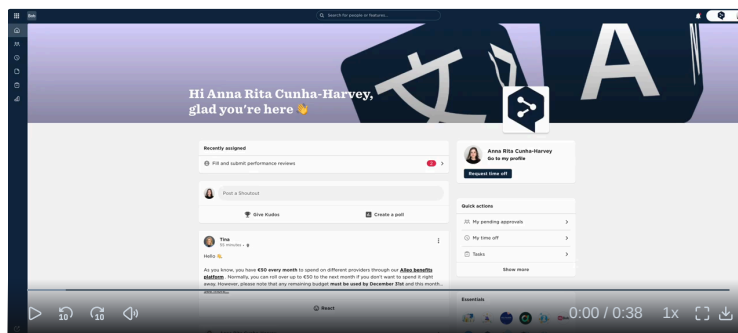
⚠️ **Note:** Your lead will only be able to see your feedback **after** they have completed their lead reflections and have had their own performance conversation with their lead.

You can view an **example** of upward feedback [here](#).

🗨️ What will this look like in HiBob?

You will start by receiving an email and slack notification to let you know you have a pending Upward Feedback request.

Check out the video below for a preview of the Upward Feedback process in HiBob:



Peer Feedback

The **aim** of peer feedback is for you to provide and receive insights on peers/stakeholders you have collaborated with so that everyone can gain a better understanding of their strengths and areas for improvement.

👋 Requesting Peer Feedback

What will I need to do?

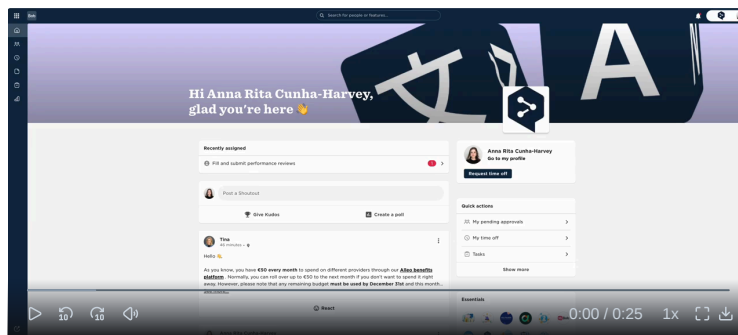
With your lead, discuss 2-3 peers/stakeholders from whom you both believe it would be good to request feedback.

Once aligned with your lead, go into the [My Reviews](#) section in HiBob and send the peer feedback requests (guidance in the video below).

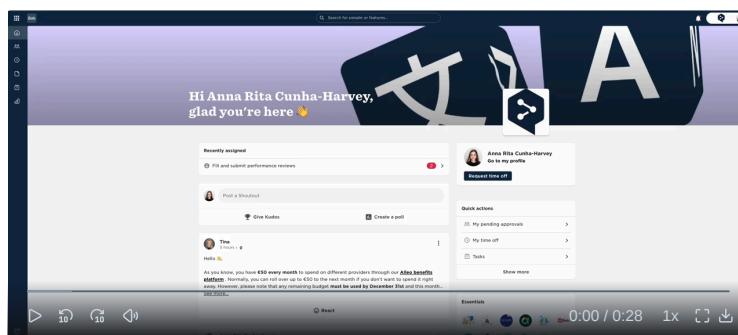
Note: if needed, your lead will be able to send out these requests on your behalf.

👁️ What will this look like in HiBob?

Requesting Peer Feedback:



Viewing the Peer Feedback shared with you:



👋 Sharing Peer Feedback

What will I need to do?

You'll be asked to answer **two questions** based on your observations and experiences working with the individual.

The first question relates to the strengths you have seen the individual display and the second question asks what you believe the individual could do to deliver greater impact. For both questions, you should reflect on:

1. Their collaboration & communication.
2. Their impact.
3. Their mastery of the skills required for the role.
4. Their growth mindset.

Note:

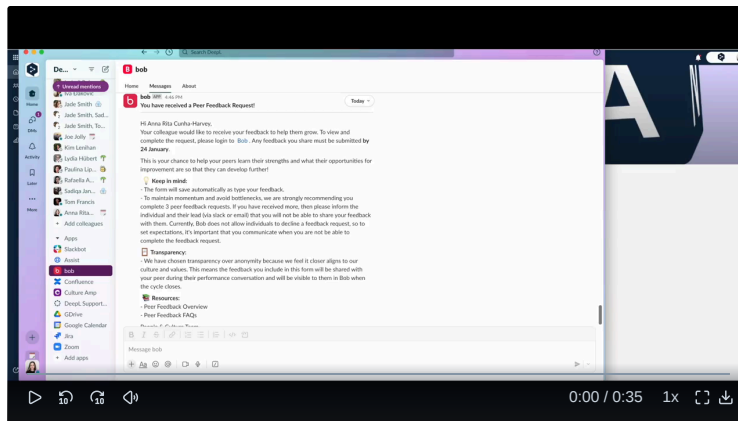
- The amount of peer feedback requests you'll be expected to respond to is **3**. Check out what to do [here](#) if you receive more than 3 feedback requests.
- The peer feedback you have provided will be shared with them by their lead during their performance conversation or will be shared automatically at the end of the performance cycle. Alternatively, you can also opt to share the feedback directly with them in Bob.

You can view an **example** of peer feedback [here](#).

👁️ What will this look like in HiBob?

Completing a Peer Feedback Request:

You will start by receiving an email and slack notification to let you know you have received a Peer Feedback request.



? FAQs

Table of Contents

Performance Reflections - Overall

- ➔ What is the purpose of reflecting on performance?
- ➔ Who will be reflecting on performance during this process?
- ➔ How often will the Performance Reflection process happen?
- ➔ Who will be eligible for the 2025 Performance Reflections?
- ➔ Who will be eligible for the 2025 Salary Review?
- ➔ How do the various elements of the Performance Cycle connect?
- ➔ Why do Performance Conversations not happen right after the Self-Reflection period?
- ➔ Why not have the Performance and Salary Conversations grouped together?
- ➔ How do performance reflections impact rewards and recognition?
- ➔ What is calibration?
- ➔ How will my performance be assessed?
- ➔ How do we reflect on individual performance in the wider context of the team?
- ➔ What do the different performance indicators mean for my development?
- ➔ Will there be feedback training for everyone?
- ➔ Will my leads feedback be shared with me?
- ➔ What should I do if I disagree with my leads' performance reflection?
- ➔ Will my historical performance data be visible to my new Lead when my Lead changes?

Self-Reflection

- ➔ How do I access my Self-Reflection in HiBob?
- ➔ What happens when I submit my Self-Reflection?
- ➔ How should I prepare for my self-reflection?
- ➔ Can I edit my self-reflection after I've submitted it?

Upwards Feedback

- ➔ What should I do if I haven't shared upwards feedback before?
- ➔ Will my lead see the feedback that I shared about their effectiveness and will they know it came from me?
- ➔ What should I do if I have only been reporting to my current lead for a short period and I do not feel able to share feedback with them yet?
- ➔ Why did we choose the transparent feedback approach?
- ➔ Could you share an example of what Upward Feedback could look like?
- ➔ If I have additional questions who can I speak to about the upward feedback process?

Peer Feedback

- ➔ How many people can I request peer feedback from?
- ➔ What should I do if I receive more than 3 peer requests for feedback?
- ➔ Will my peers see the feedback that I shared about them came from me?
- ➔ Could you share an example of what Peer Feedback could look like?
- ➔ If I have additional questions who can I speak to about the peer feedback process?

Resources & Support

- ➔ What other resources are available to individuals to support the Performance Reflection process?
- ➔ How can I share suggested improvements for the performance reflection process?

Performance Reflections - Overall

➔ What is the purpose of reflecting on performance?

Reflecting on performance is an essential practice to help each individual to grow, learn, and improve. It is a great checkpoint to acknowledge and celebrate our achievements, to understand how we got there, and to think about what we could have done differently and where we can improve.

➔ Who will be reflecting on performance during this process?

For the 2025 cycle Performance Reflections will be completed by each [eligible](#) individual (self-reflection) and their lead (lead reflection). Additionally, from 2025 we are also including peer feedback and upward feedback to provide a 360 view on each individual's performance.

➔ How often will the Performance Reflection process happen?

From 2025 onwards, the Performance Reflection process will happen once a year at the start of the year.

➔ Who will be eligible for the 2025 Performance Reflections?

The below individuals will be eligible for the 2025 Performance Reflections:

- Joined DeepL on or before 1 October 2024
- Not offboarding from DeepL
- Must be an internal employee (i.e. not an external contractor). EORs are included.
- Not on Leave of Absence for the full reflection period (1 Jan - 31 Dec 2024)

Note: the above applies to Self and Lead Reflections. Everyone (regardless of the above criteria) will receive a request for Upwards Feedback and can receive a Peer Feedback request.

➔ Who will be eligible for the 2025 Salary Review?

Any employee who has joined DeepL for more than 6 months before 1st April of the cycle year (i.e. for the 2025 review this includes folks who joined on or before October 1st, 2024) is eligible for review, including employees on leave with the exception for employees on garden leave, notice period or Performance Improvement Plans.

Please note: being eligible for the Salary Review does not guarantee a salary increase.

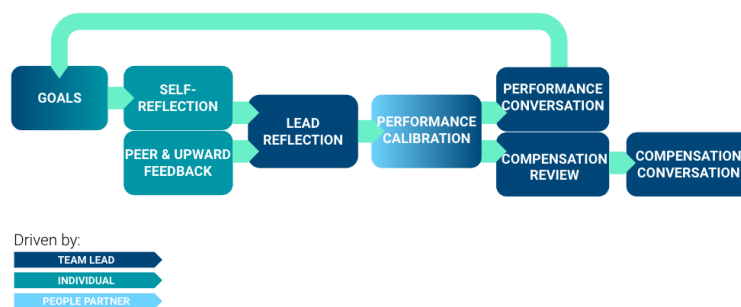
➔ How do the various elements of the Performance Cycle connect?

The different elements of the Performance Cycle are all interconnected.

To summarise how they come together:

- **Goal Setting** - is at the foundation of our **Quarterly Goal-Check-ins** and is an important reference point for the 'What' section of your Self-Reflection. Goals tell you what you should be working on and what success looks like.
- **Self-Reflections, Upward & Peer Feedback** - are essential elements of the overall Performance Reflection process and feed into the Lead Reflection.
- **Lead Reflection** - this will be discussed during the **Performance Calibration** sessions. In these sessions, [Performance Indicators](#) will also be calibrated for fairness and consistency.
- **Performance Calibration** sessions - following this, Leads will host a **Performance Conversation** with each team member. In parallel, the calibrated Performance Indicators will be used to recommend salary increases during the **Compensation Review** (note that although Bob will share a recommendation, the final decision will remain with the lead and their leadership team). After the Compensation Review is finalised, leads will host a **Compensation Conversation** with each member of their team.
- **Performance Conversation** - in addition to the Quarterly Goal Check-ins, the outcomes of this conversation can be used as a check-point to update your Goals for the upcoming period.

👁️ To help you visualise this:



➔ Why do Performance Conversations not happen right after the Self-Reflection period?

The gap between the end of the Self-Reflection period and the Performance Conversations is due to:

1. The additional period that leads have to complete their **Lead Reflection** following the end of the Self-Reflections, Peer Feedback and Upward Feedback. This period is necessary so your lead can take into account your Self-Reflection, Peer Feedback and (if applicable) Upward Feedback from your direct reports when reflecting on your performance.
2. The **calibration** period. Calibration sessions happen to ensure consistency and fairness of standards across similar job roles and levels, reducing bias and ensuring performance is assessed equitably for contributions, achievements and behaviours. During these sessions, there can still be changes to the performance indicators that

leads have selected. Therefore, it's important that all aspects of the Lead Reflections be finalised before this is shared with you.

➔ Why not have the Performance and Salary Conversations grouped together?

Based on the timeline [shared above](#), the salary review will happen after the end of the performance calibration period. With that, the salary reviews will only be finalised in April.

Although **leads can opt to group the Performance and Salary Conversations into one conversation**, we are aware that this would leave an even larger gap between the end of the Self-Reflection period and moment of the Performance Conversation. Therefore, we recommend that leads host their Performance Conversations in parallel to the salary review period and host the Salary Conversation separately after the end of the salary review.

➔ How do performance reflections impact rewards and recognition?

Individuals who are eligible for the salary cycle can be recommended for salary increases based on their performance or career progression (promotion into a new job level).

When considering salary decisions, leads will take into account 3 factors:

1. The individual's position in range which is calculated by looking at the individual's current salary compared to the salary range for the role. Salary ranges are determined by role, level and location, and are benchmarked externally to ensure we are competitive in the market.
2. The individual's performance indicator and the contributions they have made to the team and DeepL during the period, including what they have delivered, and how.
3. The budget that is available for salary review.

Not all individuals will be eligible to receive a salary increase during the review cycle, it will depend on the above 3 factors.

Salary ranges will be available to leads for their direct reports, and we will continue to evaluate the transparency and visibility of those ranges in the future.

At the moment VSOPs are not part of salary review, but this will also be reevaluated for future cycles.

➔ What is calibration?

Calibration is a workshop session in which leads review and discuss the performance indicators across a team/department/division. It is used to ensure consistency and fairness of standards across similar job roles and levels, reducing bias and ensuring performance is assessed equitably for contributions, achievements and behaviours.

➔ How will my performance be assessed?

At DeepL we place equal emphasis on both the 'what' and the 'how' of performance. We care equally about the contribution you bring towards the team and company goals, AND the way you get things done aligned to our values. Reflections will take into account both the 'what' and the 'how'.

Your lead will be asked to assign a Performance Indicator for both the 'what' and 'how'. Performance indicators will be calibrated for fairness and consistency of standards, and they will be used to (a) tailor development action (including helping people get back on track) and (b) fairly allocate reward and recognition.

During your performance conversation with your lead, they will share their feedback and your performance indicator.

The 3 performance indicators are:

- 🔄 Change Needed
- 🎯 Delivers Crucial Value
- 📈 Bar Raiser

You can find definitions for each of the Performance Indicators below:

The 'What'		
 Change Needed	 Delivers Crucial Value	 Bar Raiser
Improvements required to meet the expected standards for the role. Focus on development and support to enhance performance. • Achievements, contributions and efforts did not deliver the expected value and impact. • Did not make tangible progress towards goals and/or are not meeting the Role Expectations for their job level. • Delivered work that often missed the mark on quality and/or quantity. • Unable to keep up with the pace of work, often missing deadlines or requiring additional supervision.	Integral team member who consistently meets and sometimes exceeds expectations, adding significant value for the team's success. • Achievements, contributions and efforts consistently add impactful value to the team and DeepL. • Made clear contributions and progress towards their goals, and are meeting the Role Expectations for their job level. • Produces high quality work with the appropriate level of supervision for their role. • Committed to achieving results and contributing to team success.	Elevates the team, consistently exceeding expectations, and setting new standards of excellence. • Achievements, contributions and efforts are exceptional and have a transformative impact on the team and DeepL. • Exceeded most or all of their goals and regularly exceeds the Role Expectations for their job level. • Leads the way, driving innovative solutions and significant improvements for the team and organisation. • Inspirational role model for the team elevating standards of performance and pushing the boundaries.

The 'How'

 Change Needed	 Delivers Crucial Value	 Bar Raiser
Inconsistently demonstrates the soft skills and behaviours we require at DeepL. It could be that they need some course correction on a particular soft skill, or that more wide-ranging intervention is required. Examples: - Struggles to work with team members effectively, often choosing independent routes over teamwork. - Rarely communicates updates or challenges. - Limited influence on peers/stakeholders, pushing personal views without seeking alignment/buy-in from the team. - Hesitates to take action or make decisions (where appropriate), needing frequent guidance, which can hinder progress. - Shows resistance to new approaches and shows limited engagement in upskilling or expanding expertise. - Displays behaviours that contradict DeepL's values, impacting the team's positive work environment.	Consistently exhibits the soft skills and behaviours expected of our DeepLers. We expect the vast majority of individuals to be operating at this level when considering 'how' they delivered positive impact in their role. Examples: - Works well with others, contributes actively to group discussions & creates a supportive team environment. - Consistently keeps the team informed on their progress and is open about challenges. - Able to influence team decisions by providing balanced perspectives, helping drive projects forward. - Makes timely decisions within their scope, enabling smooth project flow without frequent guidance. - Open to feedback and actively implements it. - Regularly pursues learning opportunities that enhance their impact. - Embodies DeepL's values, positively contributing to a culture of respect, collaboration, and inclusivity.	Consistently exceeds and surpasses how we expect our team members to show up at DeepL. They elevate all others around them, and consistently have a net-positive impact on any and all working environments and teams that they operate within and around. Examples: - Goes out of their way to break down silos with and across teams, solving problems collaboratively. - Proactively communicates across teams, anticipates challenges & provides solutions before they escalate. - Inspires and guides peers to improve processes & gains alignment on complex or high-stakes projects. - Consistently acts outside their day-to-day scope if they identify an issue that impacts the business. - Actively seeks out feedback, turning it into growth opportunities. Focuses on ongoing skill development, sharing insights/training to elevate the team. - Embodies and elevates DeepL's values, creating an environment where everyone feels encouraged to excel and be the best version of themselves.

➔ How do we reflect on individual performance in the wider context of the team?

This will look different based on the team and function that you are in, as some teams have clearer individual targets, while others are focused on team goals. Ultimately, reflections focus on your individual contribution, and not the overall team outcomes. Reflecting on individual performance in the wider context of the team means reviewing your contribution to individual, team goals and strategic company objectives.

➔ What do the different performance indicators mean for my development?

Following your performance conversation, your lead should have shared with you your performance indicator for both the 'What' and the 'How'. The three performance indicators are Change Needed, Delivers Crucial Value and Bar Raiser. In line with the 3 performance indicators, we have shared [this guide](#) with leads to support them on next steps to enable you and your development.

➔ Will there be feedback training for everyone?

Yes! With the introduction of 360 feedback, we will be hosting feedback training for everyone. You will receive Calendar invites for the various training date options - simply join the date that's most suitable for you!

➔ Will my leads feedback be shared with me?

Yes! We want to foster a transparent and open culture of feedback at DeepL so all feedback will be shared and visible to you. After the calibration process is complete, your lead will schedule a Performance Conversation with you to hear your perspectives and verbally share the feedback. After the conversation, your lead will be able to share the written feedback with you via HiBob. If they do not share the feedback in the system at this point, it will automatically be shared with you when the cycle closes.

➔ What should I do if I disagree with my leads' performance reflection?

There may be times in which you disagree with your lead's feedback, this is natural and it is key to have a safe space for open discussion. We encourage you to approach a situation like this with a growth mindset. Some tips are:

- **Take the time to review the feedback** - It can be a lot to digest feedback on our performance. Remember our brains detect any type of threat and immediately have a fear response in the amygdala. Therefore, it's sensible to take time after receiving feedback to reflect on it. As someone receiving feedback, you should make sure you understand the specific points and the rationale behind them. Consider if there are any valid points or areas where you may have blind spots.
- **Prepare your response** - Gather evidence that demonstrates your contributions and accomplishments. Be ready to discuss specific examples.
- **Request a follow up meeting** - Ask your manager for a 1-1 meeting to discuss the performance reflection in detail.
- **Keep it professional** - Approach the meeting with a positive and open mindset. Avoid being defensive or confrontational while still being transparent on your perspective and rationale. Frame your discussion around understanding and collaboration.
- **Express your perspective** - Clearly and respectfully share your views. Use "I" statements to express how you feel about the feedback and provide your evidence. For example, "I understand your feedback about my project management skills, but I would like to highlight these specific instances where I successfully led projects."
- **Ask for Specific Examples if these were not clear** - If you feel the feedback you received is vague, ask your lead for specific examples to better understand their perspective. This can help clarify any misunderstandings and provide a more concrete basis for discussion.
- **Seek solutions and improvements** - Discuss ways to address any valid concerns and how you can improve moving forward. Ask for specific goals, resources, or training that can help you meet expectations.
- **Follow up** - After the meeting, make sure that any agreed-upon action items are outlined in an email. This ensures there is a record of the conversation and the steps both parties will take.
- **Connect with the People & Culture team** - If the issue remains unresolved and you believe the feedback is unfair or not reflective of your performance, consider discussing the matter with the People & Culture team.
- **Maintain a growth mindset** - Use the feedback, whether you agree with it or not, as an opportunity for growth. Reflect on the discussion and identify any areas where you can adapt or improve.

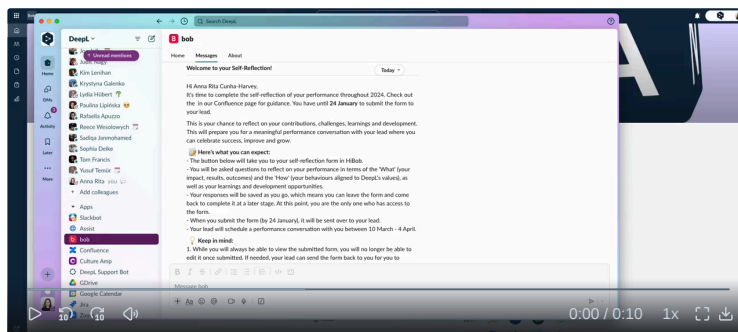
➔ Will my historical performance data be visible to my new Lead when my Lead changes?

Yes. If an employee moves to another team or has been allocated a new team lead, the new team lead will inherit all the documents and data on their new team member's Bob profile, including previous self-reflections, lead reflections and performance indicator selections.

👉 Self-Reflection

➔ How do I access my Self-Reflection in HiBob?

Check out the below video on how to access your Self-Reflection in HiBob:



➔ What happens when I submit my Self-Reflection?

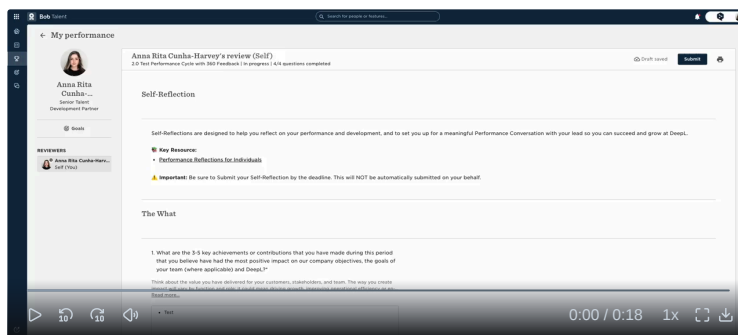
To submit your Self-Reflection, you will first need to complete all 4 questions in the Self-Reflection form.

Once completed, please click the 'Submit' button in the top right-hand corner.

Please be sure to submit your Self-Reflection as soon as it is complete. Not doing so by the stipulated deadline will cause several downstream impacts to the process.

After submitting the form, your Lead will be able to see your Self-Reflection and can take into account the contributions and achievements you have noted as they complete their Lead reflection.

Note: Although you cannot directly edit your Self-Reflection after submitting it, your Lead can send this back to you for edits until [the deadline for submitting Self-Reflections](#).



View results

Employee (You)	Manager	Peer
Anna Rita Cunha-Harvey Senior Talent Development Partner	Jade Smith Senior Director - Talent Development	[Placeholder] [Placeholder]
View	View	Invite

➔ How should I prepare for my self-reflection?

To prepare for this exercise, individuals should take the time to introspect on both aspects of their performance and what examples best demonstrate these. It is very helpful to keep track of these contributions and behaviours in an ongoing manner (as opposed to only thinking about them during the reflection process). For example, using quarterly goal check-ins as a regular reflection point, or following a moment where the employee believes they have delivered value and/or demonstrated behaviours in line with our values.

For additional guidance on writing your self-reflection, check out our [writing guide here](#).

➔ Can I edit my self-reflection after I've submitted it?

While you will always be able to view the submitted self-reflection form, you will no longer be able to edit it once submitted. If needed, your lead can send the form back to you for you to update it. For the 2025 Reflections, the last date to edit the form after your lead sends it back to you is 24 January.

👉 Upwards Feedback

➡ What should I do if I haven't shared upwards feedback before?

We understand that it might feel strange providing feedback on your leads effectiveness. The performance cycle is designed to uphold our DeepL principles of Growth Mindset and Radical Candor so that everyone (including leaders) can benefit from feedback. The aim is for everyone to understand what they are currently doing well and what to improve. We encourage you to attend the Navigating Feedback enablement for support.

➡ Will my lead see the feedback that I shared about their effectiveness and will they know it came from me?

We have chosen transparency over anonymity because it's a DeepL value we want to be consistent in upholding throughout the 360 feedback process. Your lead is aware that not all team members will feel safe to share feedback directly. If you feel unsafe sharing feedback on your leads effectiveness you can speak to your People Business Partner who will support you.

➡ What should I do if I have only been reporting to my current lead for a short period and I do not feel able to share feedback with them yet?

If you have only recently started reporting to your lead and do not feel you have sufficient information to share feedback on their performance, you can inform them and their lead that you will not be completing the Upwards Feedback form for this reason.

If you have (recently) changed leads and would still like to [submit feedback on your previous lead](#), please align on this with your new lead and your People Business Partner (PBP). Once aligned, please raise a ticket [via Jira](#) and add your Team Lead and PBP to the 'Shared with' list once the ticket is submitted.

Shared with



Anna Rita Harvey
Creator



Share

➡ Why did we choose the transparent feedback approach?

Our DeepL value "We Are Humble, Open & Value Collaboration" describes the importance of transparent and open communication. We want to make sure that this commitment to transparency extends to how we give and receive feedback within the performance evaluation round with the intention of helping each other to learn from our experiences and celebrate together.

➡ Could you share an example of what Upward Feedback could look like?

Below you can find an example of upward feedback for the Strengths and Opportunities sections of the Upwards Feedback form.

Strengths

Kathy and I have a **weekly update meeting** where we talk about our shared project priorities in solving problems for our customers. Kathy always **communicates clearly, openly and in good time**. She's a natural collaborator and **I get all the information that I need** so that when I meet stakeholders of our team I am already aware of status updates which **enable me to focus on delivering results** for them.

Kathy has made a great impact on our **product reviews** because she has a the ability to **make connections between seemingly unrelated topics and use these insights to help us critique our work and fix weaknesses** before we ship projects. Her work in bringing knowledge management to the business in the past year demonstrates such a high level of mastery that **we have a 90% adoption rate across the business**.

Kathy is one of the easiest people to **share feedback with** because she **doesn't get defensive or derailed** when things don't go according to plan. Instead I see her **modelling a growth mindset by seeing things that fail as opportunities to grow** and **I've learned** from her that when you **incorporate that knowledge into future iterations we can all move faster**.

Opportunities

When I think about my 1:1's, I notice that **John is usually time poor and cancels our 1:1's without rescheduling when other tasks that need his attention come up**. The impact is that **I feel my 1:1's aren't a priority** and I would like more time to talk about where I would like to develop and the skills I want to learn.

When the **engagement survey results** were discussed at all hands I asked John when we could discuss our team results together. He said he would plan it into our next team meeting but **the agenda point was never added**. The impact is that as the second survey's results are about to be released **I feel uncomfortable** asking what the plan is to discuss as a team.

During the last **quarterly planning cycle**, there were delays in finalising decisions on cross-departmental priorities. John's approach to alignment between departments relied heavily on **extended meetings and multiple follow-ups**, which prolonged the process. This slowed down the decision-making process, which affected our **ability to move forward efficiently**. Being clear on meeting goals upfront and requiring department leaders to do preparation work beforehand could help streamline this in future.

➡ If I have additional questions who can I speak to about the upward feedback process?

Speak to your lead if you have questions about this process or additionally, you can reach out to the People Business Partner for your team and they will assist you.

👉 Peer Feedback

➡ How many people can I request peer feedback from?

The expectation is that you request feedback from 2-3 peers in alignment with your lead. The expectation is also that you should complete 2-3 peer feedback requests.

➔ What should I do if I receive more than 3 peer requests for feedback?

If you have received more than 3 peer feedback requests, then please politely inform the individual and their lead (via slack or email) that you will not be able to share your feedback with them. Currently, Bob does not allow individuals to decline a feedback request, so to set expectations, it's important that you communicate when you are not be able to complete the feedback request.

➔ Will my peers see the feedback that I shared about them came from me?

Yes. We have chosen transparency over anonymity because it's a DeepL value we want to be consistent in upholding throughout the 360 feedback process. Check out why we chose this approach [here](#).

➔ Could you share an example of what Peer Feedback could look like?

Below you can find an example of peer feedback for the Strengths and Opportunities sections of the Peer Feedback form.

Strengths

When John and I have 1:1's he supports me by **giving guidance** on the projects that I am working on. The impact is that **I get a healthy amount of autonomy to complete my projects** and the impact is that I know John is **always going to offer support** if I ask.

Our **team meetings** are always **well structured with opportunities** for us to understand the bigger picture of the challenges we are solving, what is happening in the business, plus opportunities for us to talk about our wins, learns and failures and recognise each other for our contributions. The impact is that meetings are **supportive for our team** because **we always have clear direction, celebrate our wins and have a safe space to talk about our failures**.

John helps us to **understand how our team feeds into the bigger picture** of our function by **pushing our initiatives out into the business by representing us at the L-Team weekly meetings** to help stakeholders understand how we are supporting them to deliver their business roadmap and this creates a positive impact across DeepL by **influencing our stakeholders to buy in and take action**.

Opportunities

When I look back on working with Kathy the only thing I can think of for how she can **take her communication and collaboration to the next level**, is to suggest she **consider supporting other teams with tools and best practices**. By doing this, **other teams can benefit from valuable insights and efficiencies** which Kathy has already mastered. For example, Kathy could create broader impact if she did some **lunch and learn sessions** and made a **playbook** for others to reference. I'm sure we could all save valuable time with cross team collaboration at DeepL through the multiplier effect.

Kathy has such strengths at what she does I would like her to speak up more in our new **monthly alignment meetings with the L-Team**. I notice **she prefers to observe when we talk about project blockers and failures** instead of modelling a growth mindset with this group like she does with other teams. This might **limit the team from benefiting fully from her perspective and insights**, especially when discussing challenges. By **speaking up more and sharing her thoughts and experiences**, I believe Kathy could help foster a culture of openness and continuous learning within the L-Team.

➔ If I have additional questions who can I speak to about the peer feedback process?

Speak to your lead if you have questions about this process or additionally, you can [submit a ticket to the People & Culture team](#).

👉 Resources & Support

➔ What other resources are available to individuals to support the Performance Reflection process?

For additional resources, please check out the 'Resources' section at the top of this page.

If you have any feedback on the available resources or believe additional enablement tools are needed, please reach out to the [Talent Development & Culture team](#). We are happy to take your feedback onboard and help create the tools our employees need to feel empowered throughout the performance cycle.

➔ How can I share suggested improvements for the performance reflection process?

We recognise this first cycle is a transition period where we are going to learn a lot, we will be reaching out to various people for feedback throughout the cycle so we can iterate for next time. If you have any pressing feedback you would like to share, please contact someone from the Talent Development & Culture team.